

Build a CLAUDE.md for Your Own Project

Week 3 · The Mindset Shift — Practical Assignment (SLO 2.9: Memory Engineering)

INSTRUCTIONS

- Watch the videos “**Creating Your CLAUDE.md**” and “**The Context Window + The Drawing Room.**”
- Pick one **real** project you use an AI agent for (work, learning, content, automation — anything).
- Write a **CLAUDE.md** for it, under 50 lines, using the four parts in the hint below.
- Submit your CLAUDE.md file by the deadline.

ASSIGNMENT

Create a CLAUDE.md for one of your own projects.

It is the file your agent reads *first, every time* — the “drawing room” it walks into. Keep it tidy and under 50 lines, and make it specific enough that a stranger could read it cold and work the way you would in thirty seconds.

Don't describe a project in the abstract — write the actual file, as if you were handing it to an agent tomorrow morning.

HINT · REFRESHER

What a CLAUDE.md is

A short plain-text file your agent reads before it does anything — your standing orientation: who you are, how you work, and what not to do. It loads into the agent's limited working memory *every task*, so **keep it under ~50 lines**. Short isn't lazy — it's respect for a real limit.

The four parts of a great one

- 1 **Purpose** — what this project is, in a sentence or two. e.g. “We turn class recordings into short lessons for teachers.”
- 2 **Hard rules** — your non-negotiables. Be specific. e.g. “Never share learner data.” “Always ask before deleting a file.”
- 3 **Pointers** — where things live. Don't paste everything in; point to it. e.g. “Formatting rules are in the docs folder.”
- 4 **How you like work done** — tone, formats, what “good” looks like. e.g. “Write in simple English. Short paragraphs. Define every new term.”

How to write it

- **Start small** — five lines is fine on day one.
- **Grow from mistakes** — each time the agent misreads something, add the one line that would have prevented it.

Avoid the three traps

- **Length** — pasting in everything and drowning the file.
- **Vagueness** — “write well” tells the agent nothing.
- **Staleness** — rules that describe last month's project, not this one.

The test for a great one

Read cold by a stranger, it should let them work like you in **thirty seconds**. Trim it like packing a small bag for a trip — only what you'd genuinely miss.

A tiny example to model (not to copy)

```

• • • CLAUDE.md 11 / 50 lines

# CLAUDE.md

## Purpose
We turn class recordings into short lessons for teachers.

## Rules – never break
- Never share learner data.
- Always ask before deleting a file.

## Where things live
- Formatting rules → the docs folder

## How we work
- Write in simple English.
- Short paragraphs; define every new term.
```

WHAT TO SUBMIT

- Your completed CLAUDE.md file (≤ 50 lines), for a real project of yours.
- One or two sentences naming the project and who/what it's for.

HOW IT WILL BE ASSESSED

Criterion	What we look for
Under 50 lines	Lean and focused; nothing pasted in that could be a pointer instead.
All four parts	Purpose, hard rules, pointers, and how-you-work are all present.

Specific, not vague	Rules and style are concrete enough to act on (no "write well").
Real & current	Describes a project you actually use, not last month's.
The 30-second test	A stranger could orient and work like you from it, fast.

Submit your `CLAUDE.md` by the deadline. Tip: write five lines now, then add one line every time your agent misunderstands you this week — that's how a great `CLAUDE.md` is really built.